



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

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Let's Start!

It's time for small talk! What do you say to new colleagues?



Learning Outcome

Accurately explain information about interests, hobbies, and preferences in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can talk about myself at work.
- I can use small talk at work.

Ask your partner:

- What things do you talk about with new people?
- What things do you NOT talk about?
- When can you start sharing personal things with new people?





Let's Explore!

Peter is having **a difficult time***! Why?

* When you have "a difficult time", things are not going well.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Silvia:** So, how are you doing? How is the work going?
Peter: I'm learning a lot. I'm finding it a bit difficult. There is a lot of information to look at!
Silvia: It takes time. Everyone says the same thing.
Peter: I'm tired! I still have a lot to do.
Silvia: Are you getting to know the computer system?
Peter: Yes, I'm starting to find my way around.
Silvia: We're having an informal get together in half an hour. Can you stay and meet everyone?
Peter: Yes. I'd like that.
Silvia: Do you live far from work?
Peter: No, I don't live far.
Silvia: How do you get here?
Peter: I take the bus.
Silvia: Well, finish up. You can join us in the boardroom in 30 minutes.





Let's Practice!

Let's find out how things are going for Peter at work!

Instructions: Draw a line from the first part of the statement on the left to the second part on the right.

- | | |
|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. So, how are | a. says the same thing. |
| 2. How is the | b. know the computer syste |
| 3. There is a lot of | c. you doing? |
| 4. It takes time. Everyone | d. work going?m? |
| 5. Are you getting to | e. information to look at! |



Let's Practice!

Let's look at small talk!

Instructions: Find and fix the mistake. Each sentence has 1 mistake.

Anne: Can you stay and see everyone?

Thomas: Shoe can join us in the boardroom in 30 minutes.

Anne: Do you live far front work?

Thomas: No, I donut live far.

Anne: Chow do you get here?

Thomas: I make the bus.





Extension Activity

What do you say on the first day? Let's make small talk!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of things to say to a North American worker.
- Write 3 questions.
- Write 3 statements.
- Practice saying them.
- Say your questions and statements to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about what to say to a North American worker.

☐ ☐

I am culturally appropriate when dealing with another worker.

☐ ☐

I talk with my partner about small talk.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- half an hour** (noun): 30 minutes
e.g. The meeting starts in half an hour.
- get together** (noun): a gathering of people
e.g. We are having an office get together in 30 minutes.
- informal** (adjective): relaxed; casual
e.g. The dinner is informal. You can wear jeans.
- system** (noun): the way of doing things
e.g. You have to learn our system of giving out work.
- information** (noun): news; facts; knowledge
e.g. There is a lot of information to read at a new job.
- to finish up** (verb): to complete what you are doing now
e.g. Finish up your work, then meet us in the cafe.





Learning Points

Small Talk at Work

When you meet new people, you exchange small talk. Small talk can be about the weather, the city you are in, or general details about you.

It is not polite to ask people about religion, politics, marital status, if they have or want children, how much money they make or how much they paid for an item.

North Americans may be surprised in a bad way if you ask these things or say these things when you do not know them well.

Talking about Yourself at Work

When you talk about yourself at work, you may use the Simple Present Tense or the Present Continuous tense.

<i>Simple Present tense</i>	<i>Present Continuous tense</i>
<i>I'm tired.</i>	<i>I'm learning a lot.</i>
<i>I have a lot to do!</i>	<i>I'm finding it a bit difficult.</i>
<i>I'd like to meet everyone.</i>	<i>I'm starting to find my way around.</i>

